

ZEYU “Claude” GAO

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EDUCATION

University of Connecticut (Storrs, CT, US)

09/2026 -

Ph.D. student & Teaching Assistant, Communication

Advisor: Prof. Saraswathi Bellur

University of Glasgow (Scotland, UK)

09/2023 - 12/2024

M.Sc., Media, Communications and International Journalism

GPA: 3.78/4.0, graduated with distinction

Thesis: “Guys, look what ChatGPT said!” A study of social media sharing of communication with bots

Advisor: Prof. Mark Tranmer

Yantai University (Shandong, China)

09/2019 - 06/2023

B.A., Journalism

GPA: 3.86/5.0, rank: 5/104

Thesis: Communicator or medium? An empirical study of the communication role of ChatGPT

Advisor: Prof. Dawei Ding

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Yantai Institute of Technology (Shandong, China)

02/2025 – 07/2026

Lecturer at Department of Journalism (full-time)

Teaching: *Introduction to Journalism & Communication, Research Methods in Communication, Digital Media Technology, Media Convergence, Graduation Thesis.*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Human-Machine Communication, Human-AI Interaction, Computational Methods

JOURNAL PAPER

Gao, Z. & Sang, Y. (2026). Do we like AI to show “thinking”? Revealing the effect of Chain-of-Thought on human perceptions. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*, 1–21. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10447318.2026.2655929>

CONFERENCE PAPER

Gao, Z. (2025). “Guys, look what ChatGPT said!” A study of social media sharing of communication with bots. *The 75th International Communication Association Annual Conference*, Denver, CO, USA.

SKILLS

Software: Python, SPSS, Claude Code

Methods: experimental design, surveys, data mining, natural language processing, topic modeling, machine learning, network analysis, structural equation modeling

AWARDS

Outstanding Paper at the China AI & Computational Communication Association

First Prize of Chinese University Advertising Competition

China National Scholarship, 8'000 RMB

Jin Zheng Yantai Scholarship, 5'000 RMB

Yantai University Outstanding Student Scholarship, 1'000 RMB

INDUSTRIAL EXPERIENCE

People's Daily Public Opinion Data Center (www.peopleonline.cn/)

02/2022 - 06/2022

Product intern

ByteDance Ltd. (www.bytedance.com/en/)

07/2021 - 09/2021

Brand intern